destruction, and continued against overwhelming and powerful

abolition of untouchability and raising of depressed classes, basic education, etc. But they have kept scrupulously aloof from the political work of the Congress, even in normal times, and much more so during periods of conflict with government. Whatever their occasional

sympathies, they believe, like most sober and well-established individuals, in safety first.

Congress work has been carried on almost entirely on the petty subscriptions and donations of its large membership. Most of the work has been voluntary and unpaid. Occasionally, in the

cities, the merchants have helped a little. The only exception to this was probably during the general elections of 1937 when some big industrialists contributed to the central election fund.

Even this fund, considering the scope of our activity, was inconsiderable. It is astonishing, and it will be incredible to westerners, with what little money we have carried on our work in the Congress during the last quarter of a century —a period when India has been convulsed

repeatedly by political activity and direct action movements. In the United Provinces, one

of our most active and well-organized provinces, and one with which I am best acquainted,

almost our entire work was based on the four anna subscriptions of our members.

armed forces, were a measure of the intensity of their feelings.

Those feelings had been there even before the arrest of their

leaders, but the arrests, and the frequent firings that followed